

Canadian Gov./ Economics





About the Course

Students will spend the first two terms on the history and structure of Canada's constitutional monarchy and on the Charter of Rights and Freedoms. They will then end the year with an introduction to economics, focusing on the history of money, the banking system, and personal finance.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

The book *Canada's Constitutional Monarchy* will be read over two years (Grades 8 and 9). However, since this is the first year this book will be introduced, Grades 8 and 9 will have the same readings in 2026-2027.

If a student hasn't studied Canada's government yet, consider having them take the Grade 7 government course first.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
8	Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 1 time/week 25 min	Dollars and Sense: A Kid's Guide to Using - Not Losing - Money Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read-aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

- ☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

In Term 2, students will be asked to do online research about their own local municipal, provincial, and federal elected officials. These assignments should be done with parental supervision to ensure internet safety.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8



Dollars and Sense: A Kid's Guide to Using - Not Losing - Money



Canada's Constitutional Monarchy



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and *Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, and/or Commonplace book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 1

Introduction

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ INTRO

Who is in charge in Canada? Is it the Prime Minister? Parliament? The Monarch? The Governor General? Canada is a constitutional monarchy and a parliamentary democracy—what do these two phrases mean, and how do they work together? Before starting your reading for today, spend a few minutes writing down or discussing with someone what you know about Canada's government and how you would answer these questions.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.15-22 "Canada is a blended family" - "where they came from."

- Why does the author talk about the institution of the Crown rather than the person of the king (or queen) when discussing the Monarch's role in Canada?
- What prompted the author to write this book?

★ TEACHER TIP

This book was written before the death of Queen Elizabeth II in 2022, so any reference to her in the book now refers to King Charles III.

Canada's Constitutional Monarchy is read over two years: half in Grade 8, and the other half in Grade 9. Since this is the first year the Alveary is including this book, both grades read the first half of the book together in 2026-2027.

WEEK 2 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 2

The History of the Crown in Canada

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.23-30 "There was a reason" - "died from disease."

- Why can Senator Eugene Forsey say that "No part of this country has ever been a republic or part of a republic"? How is Canada not a republic?

→ NOTEBOOK

Select some notable dates from today's reading and add them to your Timeline or Book of Centuries.

• DEFINITIONS

republic: a form of government in which the power belongs to a body of citizens entitled to vote and is exercised by the leaders and representatives elected by those citizens to govern according to law.

WEEK 3 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 3

The History of the Crown in Canada, cont.

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-38 "Founded on Mi'kmaq land" - "locally elected legislature."

- Describe "responsible government" in your own words. How is it "the uniquely Canadian solution to balancing American republicanism with British monarchism?"

→ NOTEBOOK

Select some notable dates from today's reading and add them to your Timeline or Book of Centuries.